

Changeling to me has always been one of the darkest of games. It gives a happy image—“The World of Balloons” as it were. Underneath that fluffy image was something different. Think about the dreams you remember, the ones that don’t dissipate in the morning light. The ones that stay with you. The frustration, fear, confusion and yes, horror. These dreams also make up the world you inhabit. Imagine a world where the ruling class are actually parasitic souls forced into human form. One where the trappings and structure of society both support and destroy it. A life that is full of contradictions, power plays and nightmares. It’s about slowly losing the war for a part of yourself and there being *nothing you can do to stop it*. World of Balloons? Maybe. With half deflated, some completely missing and the rest you desperately protect, hoping they don’t go pop.

— Kat McIvor

Birmingham, England



A rampant griffin once dared me to open a book of beauty.

It challenged me to find magic in the cracks of our everyday world, to have a sense of wonder in an age that enthrones conformity and cynicism. To make a stand, screaming at the autumn skies that our spark would not be surrendered to banality. It dared me to dream.

Changeling is about dear friends whose imagination gave color to the Feathered Serpent. It is the Artificer and the Lone Tree, the Childslayer and the Nameslave, the Chronicler and the Knight of Hope. Shards of a worldwide dreaming, shaped by storytellers and players alike.

Dreams will always be there when we close our eyes. Some must never end.

— Alfredo Garcia Padilla (Wally)

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It was on coincidence that I got to know **Changeling: The Dreaming**. For a classic World of Darkness crossover event, non-vampire PCs were needed and so I picked at random one book from all possible core rules. It was love at first sight: the mosaic-like cover. The promise of all those daydreams from

when I was a child not necessarily being only dreams. Fairy tales that do contain a little piece of truth after all. It was like a reunion with a very old friend, almost forgotten and still able to touch my inner self. And then the multitude of possible moods in only one system: From “happily ever after” over intrigues at the court to a dark and hopeless Michael-Ende-like “our world is dying, for people stopped believing in wonders”, you could find it in there. For me, **Changeling: The Dreaming** is one of the most versatile systems in the entire classic World of Darkness.

— Wolfgang Fronius

Giessen, Germany



It’s one of those games that leave a mark in a very particular way. At first, you are not sure whether you should try it or not, but when you finally play it, it leaves a lasting flavour in your mouth called “Arcadia”, which only leaves you longing for more. It’s wonderful! It stimulates the convergence between the needs to explore and exploit the setting, and the search for new and diverse ways to imagine everything inside that flows amongst Seelie and Unseelie. What dazzles me the most from **Changeling** is the way it submerges you into a sidereal journey of duality. We’ve been able

